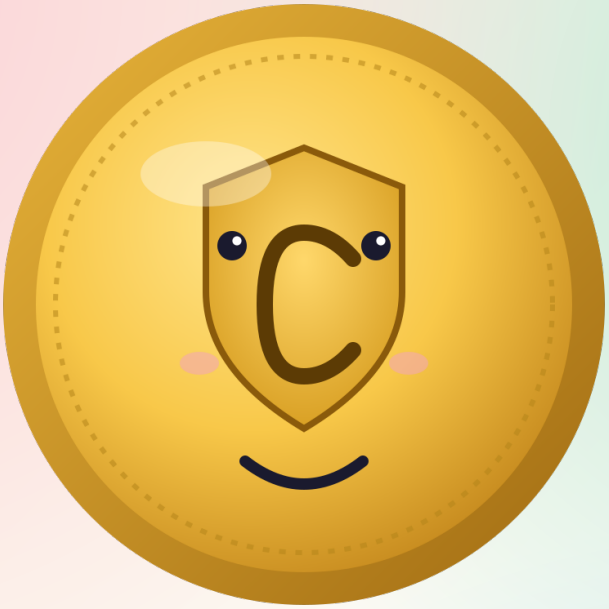


GRADE 1

Curriculum Book

C A S H

Businesses make things or do things

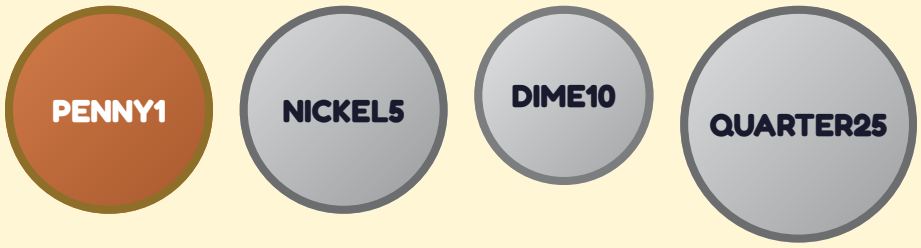
The year, big ideas, vocabulary, and project arc.

Grade 1 — Cash to Company: Curriculum Book

Year theme: Businesses make things or do things **Grade band:** K-2 (early elementary, picture-first) **Total instructional time:** ~36 weeks · 30–45 minutes per week (one short block, broken into 2–3 mini-bursts) **Anchor mascot:** Cash, the program's animated host

Why this year

Six-year-olds are sorters. They put rocks in piles. They put crayons in piles. They put their lunch into "stuff I will eat" and "stuff I will trade." First grade is when the noticing muscle from kindergarten meets the sorting muscle that comes online in first grade. We use that meeting on purpose.



Grade K of Cash to Company built one habit: helpers help, and we notice them. Grade 1 takes that habit and adds a sort. Some helpers **make a thing** — the bakery makes bread, the print shop makes signs,

the lemonade stand makes lemonade. Some helpers **do a thing** — the librarian shelves books, the dentist cleans teeth, the dog walker walks dogs. Most businesses do some of both. That last fact is the year's good first puzzle, and first graders love a puzzle they can almost solve.

The financial spine of Grade 1 is small and concrete: **counting coins up to 50 cents.** Grade K named the four coins. Grade 1 puts a small handful of coins on a mat and asks two simple questions. How much is this? And: is it enough to buy a 30-cent item? That is the year's whole money task. It is enough.

The classroom spine is the **classroom store** — a more grown-up version of Kindergarten's Cash's Cafe. Children take turns being the worker and the customer. They follow a 4-step recipe card to make a small product (trail mix, paper bookmarks, a pretend lemonade pour). They draw a sign with the **name**, the **item**, and the **price**. They tell a partner one thing the partner did well. None of it is rushed. All of it is play.

We do not teach money in any complicated way this year. We do not teach pricing strategy, profit, or loss. Those come in Grades 3 and 5. Grade 1 is about sorting, counting, ordering, and taking turns. The big lift is the sort: makes a thing or does a thing?

The big ideas (Stage 1)

These are the year's understandings, written so a six-year-old can hear them. Every unit, every lesson, and every Cash video circles back to one or more.

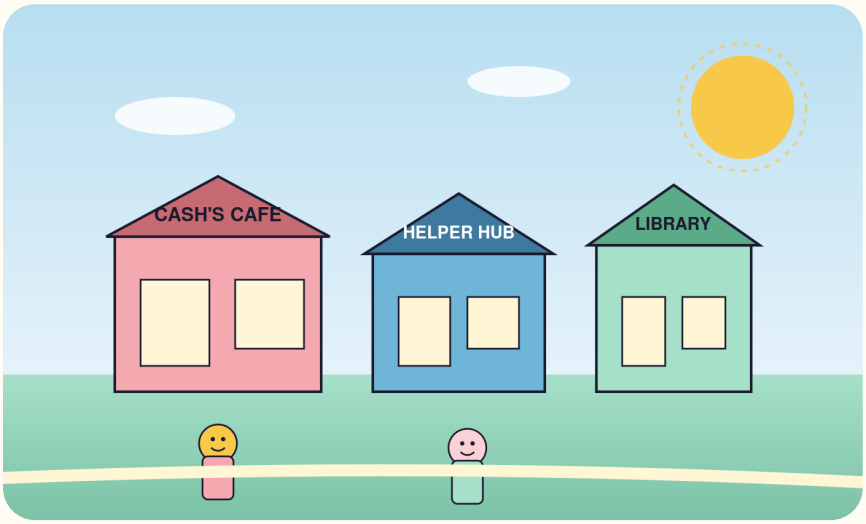
1. **Some helpers make a thing. Some helpers do a thing. Many do both.** That is how businesses work.
2. **Coins add up.** Two dimes and a nickel is twenty-five cents.
3. **Steps go in order.** A recipe card has four steps. We do them in order.
4. **A sign tells the customer three things: the name, the item, and the price.** A good sign is easy to read.
5. **A promise is something we said we would do. Keeping promises is part of being a business.**

Essential questions (returned to all year)

- Does this helper make a thing or do a thing?
- How much is this in coins? Is it enough?
- What is the next step on the recipe card?
- What does my sign tell the customer?
- Did the worker keep their promise to the customer?

CASH SAYS

Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

Year-at-a-glance — four units

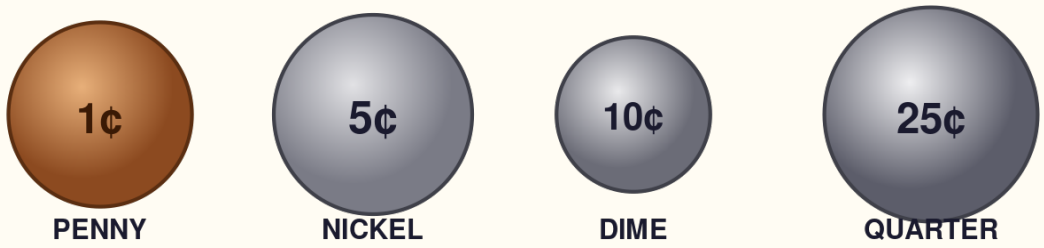
Unit	Weeks	Title	Big idea	Anchor activity / Capstone artifact
1	1–9	Make or do?	Some helpers make a thing. Some helpers do a thing.	A class **Make/Do Sort Wall** with at least 10 businesses sorted by the children.
2	10–18	Coins on the mat	Coins add up.	A child-made **Coin Mat Booklet** showing five coin combinations and their totals.
3	19–27	Follow the recipe	Steps go in order.	A **4-Step Recipe Card** the child writes (or draws) and follows to make a small classroom product (a paper bookmark or a cup of trail mix).
4	28–36	The Classroom Store	Workers and customers take turns. Promises are kept.	A class-wide **Classroom Store** open for 9 weeks, ending with a **Family Visit Day** where each child shows a sign they drew, takes a turn at the store, and says one thing their partner did well.

The **Capstone is class-wide, not individual**, with each child contributing one artifact (their sign, their recipe card, their coin

booklet, their drawing). Children rotate through three roles in the Classroom Store: **worker**, **customer**, and **sign-keeper** (the one who keeps the price sign updated and clean). On Family Visit Day, families visit, and each child tells one grown-up one helper they noticed who makes a thing, one who does a thing, and reads the price on their sign.

The 8 strand outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

By the end of Grade 1, a Cash to Company student will be able to:



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

- **BAVC** — I can sort five businesses into "makes a thing" or "does a thing" and explain my sort.
- **PSIG** — I can list three things people in my home need done and circle one that a business could do for money.
- **MFL** — I can count a mixed group of coins up to 50 cents and tell whether I have enough to buy a 30-cent item.

- **CBM** — I can draw a sign for a pretend lemonade stand that shows the name, what is sold, and the price.
- **OSO** — I can follow a 4-step recipe card (e.g., trail mix) and tell a partner each step in order.
- **LTO** — I can play the "customer" or "worker" role in a classroom store and say one thing my partner did well.
- **ESL** — I can tell whether a "promise" was kept (in a story) and explain why keeping promises matters in business.
- **LRCI** — I can show a finished classroom product (a bookmark I made) to the class and say one thing I would change next time.

Each outcome is named in at least one lesson and at least one Cash video.

Vocabulary roadmap (12 K-2 terms)

We keep the list short on purpose. Every term goes on the **Word Wall** with a picture next to it. Children point and say. Repetition is the lesson. A few terms carry over from Kindergarten — the wall starts not-blank.

1. **make** — to build a thing that did not exist before (a sandwich, a bookmark, a sign).
2. **do** — to give a service that helps a person (cut hair, walk a dog, fix a tire).

3. **business** — a place or person that helps people, often for money. (Carry-over from K.)
4. **worker** — the helper who does the job at a business.
5. **customer** — the person who comes to a business.
6. **sign** — a picture and words that tell the customer what a place is.
7. **price** — how much money something costs.
8. **cents** — small parts of a dollar; a penny is one cent.
9. **count** — to add coins together to get a total.
10. **step** — one part of a job that has more than one part.
11. **recipe card** — a card that lists steps in order.
12. **promise** — something we said we would do.

Standards alignment (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-2:** Describe how people use income for goods and services.
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** Workers can improve their ability to earn income by gaining new knowledge, skills, and experiences.
- **CCSS-Math 1.MD.C.4 / 1.OA.A.1:** Adding and comparing — applied to coin counting up to 50¢.

- **CCSS-ELA SL.1.4:** Describe people, places, things, and events with relevant details, expressing ideas and feelings clearly — used in classroom store role-play.
- **C3 D2.Eco.1.K-2:** Explain how scarcity necessitates decision making — at the level of "we only have so many cookies."
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation in a worker/customer pair.

Honest gap (named, not papered over). The "make a thing or do a thing" framing is original to this curriculum. It is not named in Jump$tart, CEE, or CCSS at Grade 1. We teach it because it is the cleanest bridge from Kindergarten's helpers help to Grade 2's businesses solve problems. By naming the gap, we give the document credibility instead of pretending all benchmarks fit.

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

Picture-first design (visual notes for the printed book)

Every spread of every K-2 book in this program is at least 60% illustration. Text is short. Type is large.

[VISUAL NOTE — cover spread] Cash, the coin-shaped mascot, stands in front of a row of small businesses. On the left: a bakery (making bread), a print shop (making signs), a lemonade stand (making lemonade). On the right: a barber shop (cutting hair), a dog walker (walking a dog), a library (helping a kid pick a book). Big letters across the top read: "MAKE OR DO?" Cash holds a small notebook.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 1 opener] A wall divided into two halves. Left half labeled MAKE; right half labeled DO. A handful of business cards are pinned: bakery (left), barber shop (right), lemonade stand (left), library (right). Two cards float in the middle, undecided: pizza shop, school. Cash points at one of them.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 2 opener] A mat with three coins on it: a quarter, two dimes, and a nickel. A small child counts on their fingers next to the mat. The total appears in big yellow numbers: 50¢. A 30-cent item (a tiny ice pop) sits next to the mat. A small thumbs-up: ENOUGH.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 3 opener] A 4-step recipe card titled "TRAIL MIX." Four small picture boxes: 1) bowl, 2) handful of cereal, 3) handful of raisins, 4) stir. Big numbers 1, 2, 3, 4 above each. A child reaches for box 2.

[VISUAL NOTE — Unit 4 opener] A classroom corner. A small wooden table with a hand-drawn sign: "MIA'S LEMONADE — 25¢." Two children stand at the table — one in a paper apron (worker), one with a paper

coin in their hand (customer). A third child holds a clipboard with the JOBS chart. The OPEN sign is up.

Sensitivity considerations specific to this year

- **No family income probing.** We never ask "how much money does your family have?" or "what does your parent do for work?" If a child volunteers a job, we receive it warmly and move on. We do not survey occupations, and we do not press for whose family has more.
- **The "do you have enough?" question.** When children practice the is it enough? coin question, we always frame it for a pretend purchase. "For a sample, you have these coins. Can you buy this 30-cent ice pop?" We never ask, and never let a child volunteer, what they actually have or do not have at home.
- **Snacks and food in the classroom store.** Many products children will sell are snacks. Avoid framing any food as "junk" or "good." Allergies are real. Use pretend food (felt or paper) in dramatic play. If a real snack is made (e.g., trail mix), check allergies first and offer a non-food alternative for any child with a restriction.
- **Real coins around small children.** Use rubber or laminated coin cards for daily handling. Pull out a small set of real coins only with adult supervision and clear hand-washing routines after.

- **Family structure.** "People in my home" is the framing for Lesson 4 (PSIG). We mean the people who live with you and care for you — a parent, a grandparent, an older sibling, a foster caregiver, anyone. Frame openly. A child who lives with one grown-up has the same chance to do the lesson as one who lives with five.
- **Promises and trust (Unit 4).** When we ask whether a promise was kept in a story, we use a story, not a child's real life. We do not ask, "has someone broken a promise to you?" We use the story instead. If a child volunteers a personal example, listen warmly, then redirect to the story.

Sensitivity flag. In Lesson 4 (Things people in my home need done), some children may name a need that reveals a private detail about their family (e.g., "my mom needs the lights fixed because they don't work"). Receive the answer warmly. Do not probe. Move on. The point of the lesson is sorting, not surfacing.

Materials and tools (year)

- A class set of coin cards (laminated, 4 coin types × at least 10 cards each).
- A small set of real coins (in a sealed jar, supervised use).
- The **Make/Do Sort Wall** — a section of bulletin board labeled MAKE on the left, DO on the right, with a fuzzy middle space.
- The Word Wall — 12 word cards with pictures.

- 4-step recipe cards (printable) — for trail mix, paper bookmarks, and a few alternates.
- Felt or paper pretend food and pretend products for the classroom store.
- Small paper aprons (4–6) and a paper "OPEN/CLOSED" sign.
- A class read-aloud library (5–7 picture books — see anchor texts below).
- Cash short videos — eight across the year, 1:30–2:00 each.
- The Grade 1 Student Activity Book — picture-first, mostly drawing and circling pages.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.

Anchor texts (read-alouds; teacher-selected, classroom library)

- Saturday Sancocho (Leyla Torres) — making a thing (a stew), step by step, with a community helper.
- The Lemonade War (Jacqueline Davies) — Grade 1 reads short excerpts only; the lemonade stand is the iconic make-and-do business.

- A Day in the Life of a Doctor (or any "Day in the Life" community-helper book) — does a thing, in steps.
- The Doorbell Rang (Pat Hutchins) — sharing, counting, and a small-batch baker.
- Officer Buckle and Gloria (Peggy Rathmann) — promises and rules at a job. (Carry-over from K.)
- Pancakes, Pancakes! (Eric Carle) — making a thing in many steps; a great Unit 3 read.

(Substitute any equivalent picture books available in the school library; the moves matter more than the specific titles.)

Project arc — the four unit capstones

Across the year, each child contributes to four named artifacts. None alone is the year's grade. Together they tell the story of a Grade 1 Cash to Company learner.

- **End of Unit 1 (Week 9):** Make/Do Sort Wall. A class wall with at least 10 businesses sorted, each child contributing one card. The artifact lives on the wall and is photographed for the class folder.
- **End of Unit 2 (Week 18):** Coin Mat Booklet. A 5-page booklet per child, each page showing one coin combination and its total in large numbers. Stapled and sent home.
- **End of Unit 3 (Week 27):** 4-Step Recipe Card. A child-drawn (or teacher-captioned) card that the child can read and follow to make

a small classroom product. Used during the actual product-making lesson.

- **End of Unit 4 (Week 36):** Family Visit Day at the Classroom Store. Each child draws a sign for a pretend stand (their name, their item, their price), takes one turn as worker and one as customer, and tells a grown-up two helpers they noticed — one who makes, one who does.

How this year hooks into the rest of Cash to Company

- **From Grade K (Businesses help people).** Kindergarten built the noticing muscle: helpers help. Grade 1 takes that muscle and adds a sort: make a thing or do a thing? The bridge is sturdy: a child who has spent a year saying "the librarian helps" is exactly ready to ask "does the librarian make a thing or do a thing?" (Answer: does. The librarian shelves and reads — a service.) The coin work in Grade K (penny, nickel, dime, quarter, "which is more?") sets up the coin counting in Grade 1 (mixed coins to 50¢). The dramatic play in Cash's Cafe sets up the Classroom Store with worker/customer pairs.
- **Forward to Grade 2 (Businesses solve problems).** Grade 2's theme is businesses solve problems. In Grade 1, students sort businesses by what they do. In Grade 2, they identify a problem and a business that already solves a problem like it. The bridge again is sturdy: a child who can say "the bakery makes bread" and

"the dog walker walks dogs" is ready to ask "what problem does the dog walker solve?" (Answer: the family is at work. The dog needs to go out.) Coin work goes from counting (Grade 1) to making change from a dollar (Grade 2). The Classroom Store evolves into a class-run problem-solving stand.

- **Vertical strands.** Each of the eight strands has a Grade 1 outcome (above). The four units braid them — for example, Unit 4 (Classroom Store) centers LTO and ESL with strong supporting beams from CBM, OSO, and LRCI.

A note to first-time teachers of this curriculum

You do not need a business background. You need to be willing to point at a bakery and say "this one makes a thing" and point at a dog walker and say "this one does a thing" about fifty times until the children are pointing first. Cash will do the heavy lifting on the videos. The lesson plans take the pacing decisions off your plate. Your highest-leverage move all year is the **sorting routine**: at the start of every Cash to Company block, hold up a business card and ask, "make or do?" — and listen to the room. By Week 12, the children will be calling out the answer before you finish the question. That is the sound of the year working.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

Senior expert upgrade pack — Grade 1

Added in the deep-think review pass.

Multi-class branching scenario — "Sam and the paper airplanes"

A two-day branching scenario that practices the make/do sort with a real choice.

- **Day 1.** "Sam loves making paper airplanes. Sam wants to start a business. Sam can sell the paper airplanes — that is making a thing. Or Sam can sell rides on the airplanes — wait, that doesn't work, but Sam can sell flying lessons — that is doing a thing. Which should Sam do?"

Class votes. Two children, one per choice, say one sentence about why.

- **Day 2.** Whichever wins the vote: dramatize for 5 minutes. Sam-the-shopkeeper and three customers. Sign on the table: SAM'S FOLDING SCHOOL or SAM'S AIRPLANES. The class sees both

make and do as real options. End with: "Some helpers make a thing. Some helpers do a thing. Many do both."

Repeatable scenario. Use again with: a kid who loves dogs (sell dog drawings = make? or walk dogs = do?), a kid who loves baking (sell cookies = make? or teach baking = do?).

Cross-grade bridge — preview to Grade 2

In the Family Visit Day at end of Grade 1, mention: "Next year, your child will look at problems and ask which business could solve each one. They started this year by sorting helpers. Next year they pick problems."

This preview takes 30 seconds and earns the Grade 2 opener.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Standards Citations (verbatim from Standards Alignment Map)

- **Jump$tart Standard 3 (Employment and Income), Benchmark 4-2:** "Describe how people use income for goods and services."
- **CEE Standard 1 (Earning Income), Grade 4:** "Workers can improve their ability to earn income by gaining new knowledge, skills, and experiences."

- **CCSS-Math 1.MD.C.4 / 1.OA.A.1:** Adding and comparing — applied to coin counting up to 50¢.
- **CCSS-ELA SL.1.4:** "Describe people, places, things, and events with relevant details, expressing ideas and feelings clearly" — used in classroom store role-play.
- **C3 D2.Eco.1.K-2:** "Explain how scarcity necessitates decision making" — at the level of "we only have so many cookies."
- **CASEL Relationship Skills:** Cooperation in a worker/customer pair.
- **Honest gap:** "Make/do" framing is original to this curriculum; designed to bridge Ks "businesses help" to Grade 2s "businesses solve."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Strand Outcomes (verbatim from Master Scope)

By end of Grade 1, a student can: - **BAVC:** "I can sort five businesses into makes a thing or does a thing and explain my sort." - **PSIG:** "I can list three things people in my home need done and circle one that a business could do for money." - **MFL:** "I can count a mixed group of coins up to 50 cents and tell whether I have enough to buy a 30-cent item." - **CBM:** "I can draw a sign for a pretend lemonade stand that shows the name, what is sold, and the price." - **OSO:** "I can follow a 4-step recipe card (e.g., trail mix) and tell a partner each step in order." - **LTO:** "I can play the customer or worker role in a classroom store and

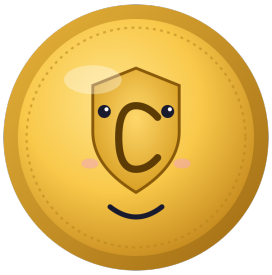
say one thing my partner did well." - **ESL:** "I can tell whether a promise was kept (in a story) and explain why keeping promises matters in business." - **LRCI:** "I can show a finished classroom product (a bookmark I made) to the class and say one thing I would change next time."

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Advanced-Learner Specifics (Grade 1)

- **Sort extension:** "Some businesses do both — they make and do." Find one (a barber who also sells hair products; a baker who also teaches a baking class). The "both" category is the seed of Grade 6s value chain.
- **Coin extension:** Compare two amounts: "Is 35¢ more than 28¢? How do you know?" Sets up Grade 2s make-change.
- **Sign extension:** Add a fourth element to the lemonade sign — who its for ("for thirsty kids"). Seed of Grade 4s 1-sentence customer statement.
- **Roleplay extension:** Be the manager who teaches another student the worker role. Seed of Grade 4s 5-minute team meeting.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 1